

ASUS MW221u

The Fast Responder

ASUS' MW221u is a TN-panel based offering boasting a response time of only 2 ms. A resolution of 1680x1050, contrast ratio of 700:1, and a brightness of 300 Cd/m² are all well in keeping with panels of this type and size.

While we couldn't find any serious fault with the build quality, it's not as good as some of the other ASUS moni-

tors we tested. The bezel is reasonably narrow, and the control buttons look really nice with a metallic finish and the way they fit flush with the panel, though they're as hard as walnuts to press. Another sore point

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆



is the stand—circular just isn't hot anymore.

A good performer with stable results throughout DisplayMate, the MW221u is a good monitor for movies and games. Although the contrast specifications put it lower than Dell's (on paper) this isn't particularly noticeable.

At Rs 23,500, the MW221u is 2,500 bucks cheaper than Dell's E228WFP. A better option as far as display quality goes, the MW221u only loses out as far as looks and ergonomics go.

Price (Rupees)—23,500

ViewSonic VX2235wm

The Finch Connection

ViewSonic has been known for many things—looks, build and great display quality. Exemplifying all this is the VX2235 a 22-inch TN panel-based beauty, decked in gorgeous piano-black finery. The build quality is good, and although the stand is quite bulky, it's well sculpted and looks cool.

The lack of a higher brightness specification (280 Cd/m²) didn't seem to affect this panel's performance in any way. Its contrast ratio of 700:1 is adequate, and the viewing angles were slightly better than those on the ASUS MW221u and the Dell E228WFP.

This was also the only 22-inch to sport in-built

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆



speakers; speakers shouldn't bias an LCD decision, and these were tinny enough to cement that opinion.

There were no issues in any of the tests—DisplayMate and MonTest sailed through with no alarms, if not flying colours. F.E.A.R. looked good on this monitor, though all three 22-inchers had issues with shadow detail, which is more of a contrast ratio

problem that typically plagues TN panels. That said, HDR looked good in Oblivion, as did the scenery—easily on par with, and perhaps better than the E228WFP.

At Rs 25,750 the VX2235wm is nearly as pricey as the E228WFP, but loses out to the well priced MW221u.

Price (Rupees)—25,750

ASUS PW201

Show With The Go

The ASUS PW201 is a great looking monitor complete with a heavy metal stand (lighter than the PG191 though) and an excellent piano-black finished body. While the bezel isn't narrow, it contains a touchpad for the controls, speakers that sound half decent (emphasis on *half*), and a 1.3 megapixel webcam. The stand allows for height adjustment, and this panel can actually be oriented face-up like a table! ASUS provides a plethora of connectivity options—D-Sub, DVI, S-Video and component. There are three USB ports as well.

One sore point was the bulky power adapter (supplied). The BenQ FP241W uses an internal adapter and ASUS should incorporate one as well.

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

The panel is a P-MVA, which means you can expect great contrast ratios as well as good colour (native 8-bit). A contrast ratio of 800:1 and a brightness of 350 Cd/m² seem



about right for this sort of panel. The PW201 had excellent viewing angles—very close to BenQ's FP241W.

Gamers concerned with the response time of 8 ms can rest easy—we noticed absolutely no ghosting or lag during our gaming benchmarks.

Geometry and colours

were up to the mark, and this monitor places behind the FP241W and 1990FX as far as DisplayMate goes. Movie-watching is as panoramic and engaging as you'd expect on a high quality widescreen such as this one.

With performance in the bag, looks covered and a feature list a mile long, the only way the PW201 could goof up is in pricing—at Rs 36,000, it's quite costly. Despite the features, the sheer performance, its looks and the connectivity options, the PW201 still seems a bit overpriced—five-odd thousand less and we'll swallow it.

Price (Rupees)—36,000